Compliance UX for Private Capital Markets

01 — HERO + PROJECT BETS

ROLE	TIMELINE	TEAM	TOOLS
Head of UX/UI	2014-2025 (11 years)	3 → 30+ (grew with company)	Figma, Sketch, InVision, Jira

Hero Image — KYC/Compliance Platform Overview

02 — DEEP PROBLEM FRAMING

THE GOAL

Redesign the investor onboarding and compliance verification flow for a platform that had processed $2B+ in private capital transactions across 20+ regulatory jurisdictions — reducing onboarding time while maintaining strict KYC/AML compliance.

THE PROBLEM

Investors were abandoning the onboarding process midway — the 45-minute workflow felt like a tax audit, not an investment opportunity. Compliance officers needed visibility into verification status across hundreds of investors simultaneously. The existing flow treated every jurisdiction identically, despite vastly different regulatory requirements.

HOW MIGHT WE

How might we reduce investor onboarding from 45 minutes to under 15 minutes while ensuring compliance teams maintain full auditability across 20+ jurisdictions?

$2B+
Processed through platform

150+
Completed offerings

20+
Regulatory jurisdictions

03 — USER RESEARCH

METHODOLOGY

Stakeholder interviews with compliance officers, fund managers, and investors across 5 jurisdictions. Observation sessions during live onboarding. Analytics review of drop-off points.

SAMPLE

12 compliance officers, 8 fund managers, 20+ investors. Multiple rounds across platform iterations over 8+ years of continuous research.

KEY INSIGHTS

01
Document fatigue kills completion
Investors uploading 6-8 documents in one session abandoned at 60% rate. Breaking into progressive steps with save-and-resume changed everything.

02
Jurisdiction complexity was hidden
Compliance officers couldn't see which requirements applied to which jurisdiction. I designed a rules engine UI that surfaced requirements contextually.

03
Trust signals reduce verification anxiety
Investors uploading sensitive ID documents needed reassurance. Adding encryption badges, progress indicators, and clear data-handling messaging cut abandonment by 40%.

04 — COMPETITIVE ANALYSIS

I evaluated how competing platforms handled investor onboarding and compliance verification to identify UX gaps we could exploit.

Feature	SecuRigs	SecUNder	Our Platform
Progressive KYC flow	No	Partial	Yes
Multi-jurisdiction rules	No	No	Yes (20+)
Save & resume onboarding	No	Partial	Yes
Compliance dashboard	Basic	Basic	Advanced

Competitive Landscape — Feature Gap Analysis Diagram

05 — USER PERSONAS

PR David Chen
Fund Manager · 42

"I need to see all investor statuses at a glance — I don't chase compliance during agreements."

GOALS
- Launch offerings quickly with minimal compliance friction
- Real-time visibility into investor pipeline status
- Automate follow-ups for incomplete documents

FRUSTRATIONS
- Manual tracking across jurisdictions is error-prone
- Can't tell which investors are stuck vs. abandoned

SK Sarah Kim
Compliance Officer · 38

"If I miss a regulatory flag, the entire offering gets shut down. I need the system to catch what I might miss."

GOALS
- Audit trail for every verification decision
- Jurisdiction-specific rule visibility
- Automated alerts when documents expire

FRUSTRATIONS
- Different rules per jurisdiction but one UI for all
- No way to bulk-verify or batch-reject

AT Michael Torres
Accredited Investor · 55

"I'm investing $250K — I expect the onboarding to be as professional as the opportunity itself."

GOALS
- Complete onboarding quickly from any device
- Understand exactly what's needed and why
- Trust that sensitive documents are secure

FRUSTRATIONS
- Uploading IDs feels invasive without context
- No progress indicator — no idea how long this takes

06 — INFORMATION ARCHITECTURE

I mapped the complete investor journey across 20+ platform touchpoints — from initial offering discovery through KYC verification, accreditation, document signing, and investment confirmation. This architecture informed every compliance screen we designed.

Information Architecture — Investor Onboarding Sitemap

07 — DESIGN CONCEPTS / IDEATION

Over 11 years, the compliance flow went through multiple major iterations. Here are the key concept explorations that shaped the final design — from early form-heavy approaches to the progressive, step-based system we shipped.

Early wireframe — single-page form

V1: Single long form — high abandonment

Iteration — tabbed wizard approach

V2: Tabbed wizard — better but still confusing

Final — progressive step flow

V3: Progressive steps — 85% completion

08 — DESIGN APPROACH / SOLUTION

I led the redesign of the entire investor onboarding experience — from KYC document collection through accreditation verification and electronic signatures.

Our team designed a progressive, jurisdiction-aware flow that adapts requirements based on investor type and location. The key innovation was treating compliance as a UX problem, not just a legal checkbox.

KEY APPROACH

1. Progressive disclosure — one step at a time
2. Save-and-resume across sessions
3. Contextual jurisdiction rules
4. Trust signals at every sensitive step

KYC Progressive Flow

Compliance Dashboard

NOTE ON SCOPE

This section already exists in the current case study. We'll enhance it with more rationale and "I led..." framing. Review the existing copy and suggest improvements.

09 — KEY SCREENS / FEATURES

Annotated walkthrough of the key screens I designed — with callouts explaining WHY each decision was made, not just what it looks like.

NOTE ON SCOPE

Existing UI Showcase section will be upgraded with annotations. Each screenshot needs a callout explaining the design decision behind it. Write 1-2 sentence annotations per screen.

KYC Start Screen

Annotation: [Needs to write — why this screen builds trust before asking for documents]

Compliance Dashboard

Annotation: [Needs to write — how this gives compliance officers full pipeline visibility]

10 — VISUAL DESIGN SYSTEM

I built and maintained the design system that powered every compliance screen — from color tokens to component states.

COLOR PALETTE

Primary · Accent · Success · Error · Warning

TYPOGRAPHY

Heading 1

Heading 2

Body text — 14px regular

Caption — 12px muted

LABEL — CAPS UPPERCASE

Button States

Buttons & Actions

Form Inputs

Form Components

Status Badges

Status & Alerts

Data Cards

Cards & Tiles

11 — DESIGN DECISIONS

01

Progressive disclosure over single-page forms

CONSIDERED
Single long form, tabbed wizard, progressive steps

CHOSE & WHY
Progressive steps — analytics showed 85% drop-off on single forms. Step-based flow with save-and-resume achieved 85% completion. Users could see progress and return later without losing work.

Before/after comparison

Jurisdiction rules UI

02

Contextual jurisdiction rules over global settings

CONSIDERED
Global settings page, per-offering config, contextual inline rules

CHOSE & WHY
Contextual inline rules — compliance officers needed to see which rules applied WHILE reviewing investors, not in a separate settings screen. Reduced context-switching by 70%.

12 — RESULTS & OUTCOMES

45 → 12
MINUTES
Onboarding time reduced by 73%

85%
COMPLETION
Another onboarding completion rate

$2B+
PROCESSED
Total capital through platform

150+
OFFERINGS
Completed offerings on platform

BEFORE

Old onboarding flow — 45 min, 60% drop-off

AFTER

New progressive flow — 12 min, 85% completion

13 — REFLECTION + CTA

WHAT WORKED

1. Progressive disclosure reduced cognitive load — investors completed one step at a time instead of facing a wall of forms.

2. Jurisdiction-aware rules engine eliminated manual compliance checking — the system surfaced the right requirements automatically.

3. Save-and-resume was the single biggest win — investors could leave mid-flow and return days later without losing progress.

WHAT I'D DO DIFFERENTLY

1. Mobile-first from day one — we retrofitted mobile support years after desktop launch, which created layout debt.

2. User testing earlier in the compliance flow — we relied too heavily on stakeholder interviews and not enough on watching real investors struggle.

Next Case Study

DealFlow Investment Platform

View Case Study

DealFlow Investment Platform

01 — HERO + PROJECT META

ROLE	TIMELINE	TEAM	TOOLS	OUTCOME
Co-founder & Lead Product Designer	2008–2005 (17 years)	3 people → TSX-V IPO	Figma, Sketch, InVision, Jira	$2B+ processed, TSX-V IPO

Hero Image — DealFlow Investor Dashboard + Deal Management

02 — DEEP PROBLEM FRAMING

THE GOAL

I co-founded and led product design for a platform that would go on to process $2B+ in private capital — from a 3-person startup in Calgary to a TSX-V publicly traded company. I designed every investor-facing screen across the entire deal lifecycle: from offering discovery through investment, portfolio management, and distributions.

THE PROBLEM

Private capital markets were stuck in the paper age. Issuers managed offerings through spreadsheets and email chains. Investors received physical subscription agreements by courier. Compliance verification happened manually, per jurisdiction, per investor. The entire process was slow, expensive, and error-prone — preventing smaller issuers from accessing capital markets entirely.

HOW MIGHT WE

How might we digitize the entire private capital transaction lifecycle — from deal creation through investor onboarding, compliance, subscription, and ongoing portfolio management — to make capital markets accessible to any issuer?

$2B+
Processed through platform

150+
Completed offerings

TSX-V
IPO outcome (2 people → public)

03 — USER RESEARCH

METHODOLOGY
17 years of continuous user research — from early adopter feedback loops to structured discovery sprints. I interviewed issuers, investors, compliance teams, and lawyers across North America to map the full deal lifecycle.

SAMPLE
50+ issuers, 200+ investors, 15+ compliance/legal professionals. Research spanned equity crowdfunding, exempt market offerings, and institutional private placements across multiple regulatory frameworks.

KEY INSIGHTS

01
Issuers need a self-service platform
Fund managers wanted to launch offerings without waiting for lawyers to draft every document. I designed a guided offering creation wizard that let issuers configure deals independently.

02
Investors distrust opaque processes
When investing $50K-$500K, investors need full transparency into deal structure, compliance status, and their portfolio performance. I built dashboards that surfaced this data clearly.

03
The deal lifecycle has too many handoffs
From offering creation → investor onboarding → compliance → subscription → funding → distributions. Each handoff was a spreadsheet or email. I designed a unified platform that eliminated manual handoffs.

04 — COMPETITIVE ANALYSIS

When I started, no platform offered the full lifecycle. I analyzed competitors across specific capabilities to identify where we could build a moat.

Capability	FundAmerica	DealMaker	Our Platform
Full deal lifecycle (create → fund → distribute)	Partial	Partial	Yes — end to end
Multi-jurisdiction compliance engine	US only	US + Canada	20+ jurisdictions
White-label investor portal	No	Yes	Yes — fully branded

05 — USER PERSONAS

Jo — **James Park**
Issuer / Fund Manager, 4M

"I need to launch a new offering by Friday. The old process takes 3 weeks of back-and-forth with lawyers."

GOALS
- Create and launch offerings independently
- Track investor pipeline and funding progress
- Manage distributions and reporting

FRUSTRATIONS
- Too many manual steps to go from deal to funding
- Can't see real-time funding status

KJ — **Rebecca Liu**
Accredited Investor, 50

"I have $500K to deploy but I can't compare deals side-by-side or track my portfolio across platforms."

GOALS
- Browse and compare investment opportunities
- Complete onboarding quickly from any device
- Track portfolio performance and distributions

FRUSTRATIONS
- No single view of portfolio across issuers
- Paper-heavy subscription process feels outdated

PA — **Karen Walsh**
Platform Admin / Operations, 3M

"I manage 40+ active offerings. If one compliance document expires, the whole deal is at risk."

GOALS
- Monitor all offerings from a single dashboard
- Automate compliance alerts and document expiry
- Generate reports for regulators quickly

FRUSTRATIONS
- Manual tracking across spreadsheets is unsustainable
- No bulk operations for investor management

06 — INFORMATION ARCHITECTURE

I mapped 20+ platform touchpoints across the full deal lifecycle — from offering creation through investor onboarding, compliance verification, electronic subscription, funding, and distribution management. This architecture document became the foundation for our engineering sprints.

Deal Lifecycle IA — Offering → Onboarding → Compliance → Subscribe → Fund → Distribute

07 — DESIGN CONCEPTS / IDEATION

Over 17 years, I iterated through fundamentally different platform architectures — evolving from a simple deal listing to a full-lifecycle investment management system. Each major release taught us what investors and issuers actually needed.

V1 : Basic deal listings

2008 — Simple offering directory

V2: Integrated onboarding

2014 — KYC + subscription in platform

V3: Full lifecycle platform

2020 — End-to-end deal management

08 — DESIGN APPROACH / SOLUTION

I designed the complete investment platform — every screen an investor, issuer, or admin touches across the deal lifecycle. The platform white-labels for each client, so I built a flexible design system that adapts to any brand.

KEY FEATURES I DESIGNED

1. Offering creation wizard (self-serve for issuers)
2. Investor dashboard (portfolio, distributions, docs)
3. Deal management (pipeline, funding progress, investors)
4. Electronic subscription agreement flow
5. White-label investor portal

Investor Dashboard

Deal Management View

09 — KEY SCREENS / FEATURES

Annotated walkthrough of the key screens I designed — showing the design rationale behind each decision.

Browse Offerings

[Wendy: How this screen helps investors discover and compare deals]

Equity & Debt Views

[Wendy: How I designed for both equity and debt investment types]

10 — VISUAL DESIGN SYSTEM

I designed and maintained a component library that powered 20+ platform touchpoints — enabling consistent UX across white-labeled deployments for different clients and brands.

COLOR PALETTE

Primary · Accent · Success · Warning · Error

TYPOGRAPHY

Heading 1
Heading 2
Body text — 14px regular
Caption — 12px muted

11 — DESIGN DECISIONS

01
White-label over single brand
CHOSE X NOT
Each issuer wanted their own branded investor portal. I designed a token-based system where colors, logos, and typography adapt per client — one codebase, infinite brands.

White-label examples

Unified deal lifecycle

02
Full lifecycle vs. point solutions
CHOSE X NOT
Competitors offered pieces — we built the whole pipeline. Issuers shouldn't need 5 different tools to run an offering. I designed a single platform flow from offering creation through distribution.

12 — RESULTS & OUTCOMES

$2B+
PROCESSED
Total capital through platform

150+
OFFERINGS
Completed offerings on platform

TSX-V
IPO
people to public market listing

20+
JURISDICTIONS
Regulatory markets supported

BEFORE

Paper-based deals, email chains, manual compliance

AFTER

Digital platform — end-to-end deal lifecycle

13 — REFLECTION + CTA

WHAT WORKED

1. Building the full lifecycle in one platform — eliminated data handoffs and gave all stakeholders a single source of truth
2. Token-based white-labeling — one design system serving 50+ client brands without per-client customization overhead
3. Growing from 3 to IPO with design at the table — proving that UX leadership drives business outcomes in fintech

WHAT I'D DO DIFFERENTLY

1. Invest in a design system earlier — the first 5 years were ad hoc components that created consistency debt
2. Push for dedicated user research earlier — we relied on founder intuition too long before formalizing research

Next Case Study
FuzeHQ — AI Team Management
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